

Ninety words tracing one thing back to where it started

0A • Find it

Find nine labels in this picture. Three of them say where something is from.

LOCAL • GROWN IN CAMERON • PRODUCT OF THAILAND • FARM FRESH • IMPORTED •
PACKED IN SELANGOR • NO ORIGIN GIVEN

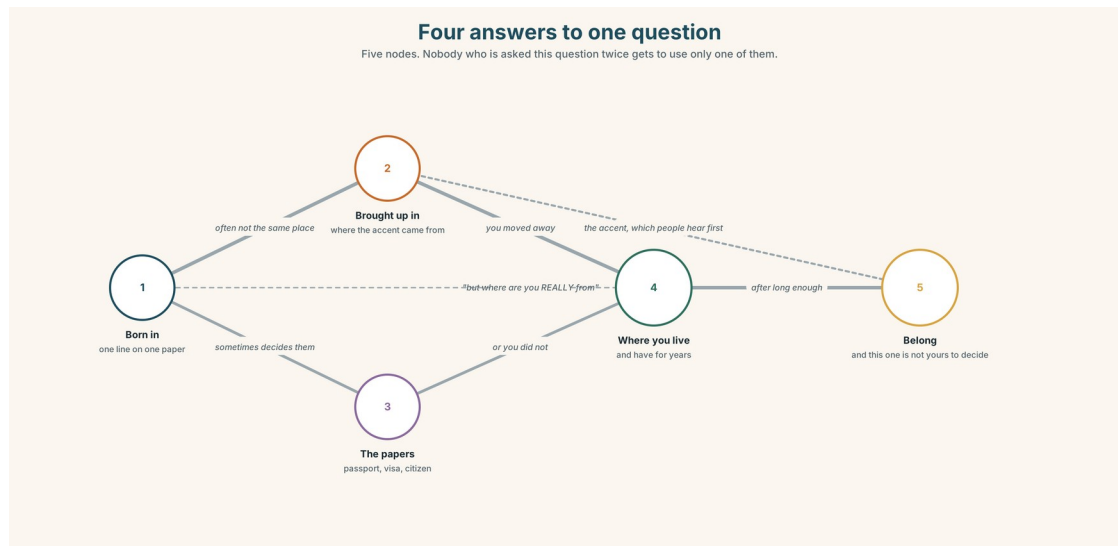
0B • Guess it

One label in this picture is true but misleading. Which, and what does it leave out?

0C • Say it

Record thirty seconds. *Where are you from, and how many sentences does it take to answer that honestly?* You will record it again at the end of this unit.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM



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Four answers to one question — Five nodes. Nobody who is asked this question twice gets to use only one of them.

1A • Meet — where people come from

Match each word to one place on the map.

born • raise • move • family • home • village • town • country • roots • settle

1B • Sort — a place, a paper, or a feeling?

Three columns.

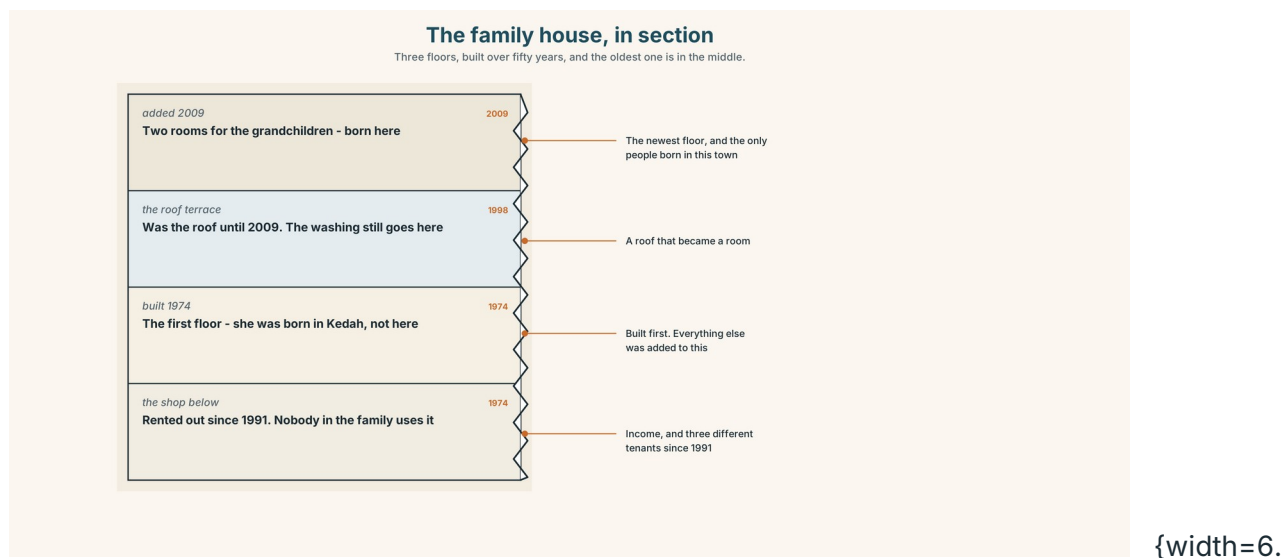
passport • home • village • visa • belong • roots • country • citizen • accent • town

One of them changes column depending on who is asking. Which?

1C • Meet — the ones people notice first

accent • language • foreign

An accent tells people where you learned to speak. **It does not tell them where you are from. Give one example from your own country.**



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The family house, in section — Three floors, built over fifty years, and the oldest one is in the middle.

Look at the family house in section. Three generations, three floors. **Which floor was built first, and who was born in a different country?**

1D • Stretch — the phrases

Complete each one with one word.

1. She **was** _____ in Penang but has never lived there.
2. He **was brought** _____ by his grandmother in a village of two hundred people.
3. They **moved** _____ in 1998 and have been back twice.
4. Every year in April she **goes** _____ for a week.
5. I **grew** _____ two streets from here.

1E • The saying

f It's complicated.

Two words people use when the real answer takes four sentences.

"Where are you from?" — "It's complicated."

What are the four sentences? Write them for somebody you know, real or invented.

1F • Own it

Tell a partner **three sentences** about where you are from: one with a place, one with a date, and one that complicates the first two.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



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The sign says local — One of them hung it. One of them has never said the word out loud.

2A • The sign says local 🎧 Track 7.1

Before you listen. The stall has a sign saying LOCAL. Half the produce comes from 400 km away.
Guess: does Siti know?

Listen once. One question. Who put the sign up?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Where is it grown?	How far?	What the label says
tomatoes			
long beans			
garlic			

Listen again. True or false?

- The garlic is grown in Malaysia. ☐ T ☐ F
- The sign was put up by Hafiz. ☐ T ☐ F
- Nobody has ever asked about it. ☐ T ☐ F
- The tomatoes travel further than the beans. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- Somebody put the sign up last year.*
- The sign was put up last year.*
- They grow the garlic in China.*
- The garlic is grown in China.*

Two of these name the person. Two do not. Which, and **which pair sounds more like a label?**

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 7.2

Twenty-five seconds of Hafiz. Four jobs.

1. How many times does he say *is grown* or *are grown*?
2. In *packed*, can you hear a *d*, a *t*, or neither?
3. Catch the two distances he gives.
4. He says one thing twice, in two different ways. What?

Transcripts, page 156.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

When nobody is named

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2.

1. Sentences 1 and 2 describe the same event. **What is in one and missing from the other?**
2. In sentence 4, where has *they* gone?
3. Why would a label use sentence 4 rather than sentence 3?
4. **Is leaving the person out always dishonest?** Give one example where it is not.
5. Try "*The garlic is grow in China.*" **What is missing?**

3B • See

The same event, two first words
Active starts with the person. Passive starts with the thing, and can end without one.

ACTIVE	They	grow	the garlic in China
⇕ same event, different first word			
PASSIVE	The garlic	is grown in China	(by whom?)

Three reasons to use the passive: nobody knows who, it does not matter who, or somebody would rather you did not ask. Only the third is suspicious.

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The same event, two first words — Active starts with the person. Passive starts with the thing, and can end without one.

Now look at the second picture. **The sentence has three slots. Which one can be deleted?**

The slot you can delete

Every passive sentence has a by-slot. Most of the time it is empty on purpose.

The

sign

was

put

up

last

year

by

Hafiz

the thing, promoted to first

be + past participle

delete this and the sentence still works

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The slot you can delete — Every passive sentence has a by-slot. Most of the time it is empty on purpose.

3C • Know

	Shape	Example
present passive	am / is / are + past participle	The garlic is grown in China.
past passive	was / were + past participle	The sign was put up last year.
naming the agent	by + who or what	It was built by my grandfather.

Three reasons to use the passive, and only one of them is suspicious:

- Nobody knows who → The sign was put up last year.
- It does not matter who → The garlic is grown in China.
- Somebody would rather you did not ask → Mistakes were made.

Watch out. The participle is not the infinitive. × is grow ✓ is grown · × was build ✓ was built

Why it matters. The passive lets you put the important thing first and the person last — or nowhere. On a food label, that is a decision, not a grammar choice.

3D • Use — controlled

The tomatoes (1) _____ (grow) in Cameron Highlands and (2) _____ (bring) down overnight. The garlic (3) _____ (not grow) here at all; it (4) _____ (import) from China and (5) _____ (pack) in Selangor. The sign (6) _____ (put up) last year by a man nobody can now name.

3E • Use — guided

Make each one passive. Leave out the agent if it adds nothing.

- They grow the beans in Johor.
- Somebody stole the scales on Tuesday.
- My grandfather built this house.
- They pack the garlic in Selangor.
- Somebody has moved the noticeboard.

3F • Use — open

Choose one thing in this room. Tell a partner three passive sentences about it: where it was made, what it is made of, and who it was bought by.

3G • Check — six items

1. The rice _____ (grow) in Kedah.
2. This house _____ (build) in 1961.
3. The crates _____ (bring) down every night.
4. The sign _____ (put up) by Hafiz last year.
5. Garlic _____ (not grow) in Malaysia.
6. Where _____ these _____ (make) ?

0–3 → Workbook pp. 40–42. 4–5 → Part 6. 6 → page 151.

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — where is it from?

One learner holds up any object. The others must give **three passive sentences** about it in thirty seconds. **No guessing allowed to be challenged.**

Five objects. Five rounds.

4B • The functional core — tracing something back

The label, and the delivery record
Learner A has the records. Learner B has the labels. Two of them disagree.

the label, at eye level

printed, large, above the crates



the box, on the floor

PRODUCT OF CHINA, in 9pt



Which two products do the label and the record disagree about?

7 differences — find them all

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The label, and the delivery record — Learner A has the records. Learner B has the labels. Two of them disagree.

Language Bank

the origin

It's grown in... · It was made in... · It comes from...

the journey

It's brought down overnight. · It's

the method
the honest gap

*sent by road. · Then it's packed in...
by hand · by machine · at the factory
Nobody knows who... · The label
doesn't say. · It's complicated.*

Information gap. Learner A has the delivery records. Learner B has the labels. Neither sees the other. **Find the two products whose labels and records disagree.**

4C • The performance — eighty seconds

Trace **one everyday thing** back to where it started. **Eighty seconds.** You must give:

where it is grown or made · how it travels · what is done to it on the way · one thing you cannot find out

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did the speaker admit what they could not find out?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did I use at least four passive forms? ☐ Did I name an agent where it mattered, and leave it out where it did not?

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

A feature article. The title is "**The word *local* is not regulated.**" **What do you expect the article to find?** One sentence.

5B • Read — one hundred and ten seconds

The word *local* is not regulated

There is no law in this country about the word *local*. It is not defined anywhere. A sign saying LOCAL PRODUCE can be hung above vegetables grown four hundred kilometres away and nothing has been broken.

We looked at forty-one stalls in one market. Twenty-nine had a sign using the word. Of those twenty-nine, eleven were selling at least one item that had been imported from another country, and all eleven were doing it openly: the boxes were stacked behind the stall with the country of origin printed on the side.

Nobody was hiding anything. That is the interesting part.

When we asked traders what *local* meant, we were given four answers. It meant *grown in Malaysia*. It meant *not from a supermarket*. It meant *I know the man who brings it*. And, from one trader who had been there thirty-one years, it meant *you are buying it from me and not from somebody in an office*.

That last answer is the one the sign is really making. It is not a claim about geography. It is a claim about who you are handing your money to, and on that measure every one of the twenty-nine signs was telling the truth.

The boxes, however, are still behind the stall. Somebody chose to put the sign at eye level and the boxes on the floor, and that choice was made by a person, even if nobody can now remember which one.

5C • Answer

- 1. Is the word *local* defined in law?
- 2. How many of the forty-one stalls used the word, and how many of those sold imported items?
- 3. **Why does the writer say "nobody was hiding anything" is the interesting part?**
- 4. What were the four meanings traders gave?
- 5. Which meaning does the writer think the sign is really making?
- 6. What is the writer's last point about the boxes?

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

regulated • defined • at eye level • on that measure • openly

5E • The counter-text

Three labels and one delivery record

Two of them name a country. One names a company and lets you assume the rest.

LABEL 3 - GARLIC

Printed

~~BROWNIE'S LOCAL PRODUCE~~ BROWNIE'S LOCAL PRODUCE Sdn Bhd

Designed

8888888888888888

PACKED IN

names where the bag was filled. It does not name where anything was grown, and there is no requirement that it should.

DELIVERY RECORD, 11th

ITEM	FROM	KM
Tomatoes	Cameron Highlands	172
Long beans	Nakhon Pathom, TH	1,140
Garlic	Sri Murni, Selangor	38
Garlic (origin)	Shandong, CN	4,290

THE STALL SIGN, ABOVE ALL THREE:

"LOCAL PRODUCE"

A real place, and the only label that gives one

A country, printed plainly, and the furthest of the three

A company, not a country

Four words that most shoppers read as an origin

Thirty-eight kilometres - and four thousand two hundred and ninety

Hung above all of it, and not regulated anywhere

6in}

Three labels and one delivery record — Two of them name a country. One names a company and lets you assume the rest.

Read the three product labels and the delivery record, and answer.

1. Which label gives a country, and which gives only a company?
2. **Which product travels furthest, and does its label say so?**
3. What does *PACKED IN* mean, and what does it not mean?
4. One label has no origin at all. Is that legal?

5F • Two texts

The feature says eleven stalls sold **imported items**. The delivery record shows garlic arriving from a **Selangor packer**, not from abroad.

Put those two facts together. Where is the garlic from? Two sentences.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

How things are made and moved

Grown, made, moved, sold
Four verbs, and each one hides a different thing.

1 grown in Shandong  IS GROWN - and the farmer is not named the field	2 packed in Selangor IS PACKED - and this is the step people read	3 sent by road, overnight  IS BROUGHT - thirty-eight kilometres	4 sold at stall 14  IS SOLD - by a person, at last the stall
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6in}

Grown, made, moved, sold — Four verbs, and each one hides a different thing.

6A • Sort — grown, made, or moved?

Three columns.

grown • made • built • sold • sent • brought • taken • given

Two of them could be in two columns. Which, and with what?

6B • Chunk completion

1. These are **made** _____ Vietnam.
2. The beans are **grown** _____ Johor.
3. The house was **built** _____ my grandfather.
4. It's **sold** _____ the far end, not here.
5. Each one is finished **by** _____ — you can see the marks.
6. The rest are cut **by** _____, four hundred an hour.

6C • Three words that hide a step

packed • processed • distributed

Each of these tells you something was done — and hides where the thing started.

Write one sentence with each, and then rewrite it naming the country of origin.

By hand, and by machine

The same product, two methods, and two things the label will not tell you.

BY HAND

forty an hour, and you can see the marks



BY MACHINE, AT THE FACTORY

four hundred an hour, all identical



Which one does the label mention, and why that one?

6 differences — find them all

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6in}

By hand, and by machine — The same product, two methods, and two things the label will not tell you.

Six differences. Find them, then answer the question under the picture.

6D • Contrast Clinic — active or passive

Six items. Choose the better one, and say why.

1. Somebody stole the scales. / The scales were stolen.

2. My grandfather built this house. / This house was built by my grandfather.

3. They grow garlic in China. / Garlic is grown in China.

4. Mistakes were made. / We made a mistake.

5. The sign was put up last year. / Somebody put the sign up last year.

6. The crates are brought down overnight. / They bring the crates down overnight.

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The -ed you cannot hear

The -ed you cannot hear

Three endings, and one of these words has no -ed in it at all.

packed	→	p æ k t	-ed sounds like a t
sold	→	s ə u l d	a d, and no extra syllable
imported	→	ɪ m ' p ɔ : t ɪ d	a whole extra syllable: /ɪd/
grown	→	g r ə u n	not an -ed word at all
built	→	b ɪ l t	irregular, and ends in t anyway

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6in}

The -ed you cannot hear — Three endings, and one of these words has no -ed in it at all.

7A • Hear Track 7.3

packed → /pækt/ — a **t** grown → /grəʊn/ — not an -ed word at all imported → /ɪm'pɔ:tɪd/ — a whole extra syllable sold → /səʊld/ — a **d**

7B • Say

Say each one. Then say the sentence three times, faster:

It's grown in China, packed in Selangor and sold here.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

It's PACKED in Selangor. (and that is all that happens there) It's packed in SELANGOR. (not here, whatever the sign says)

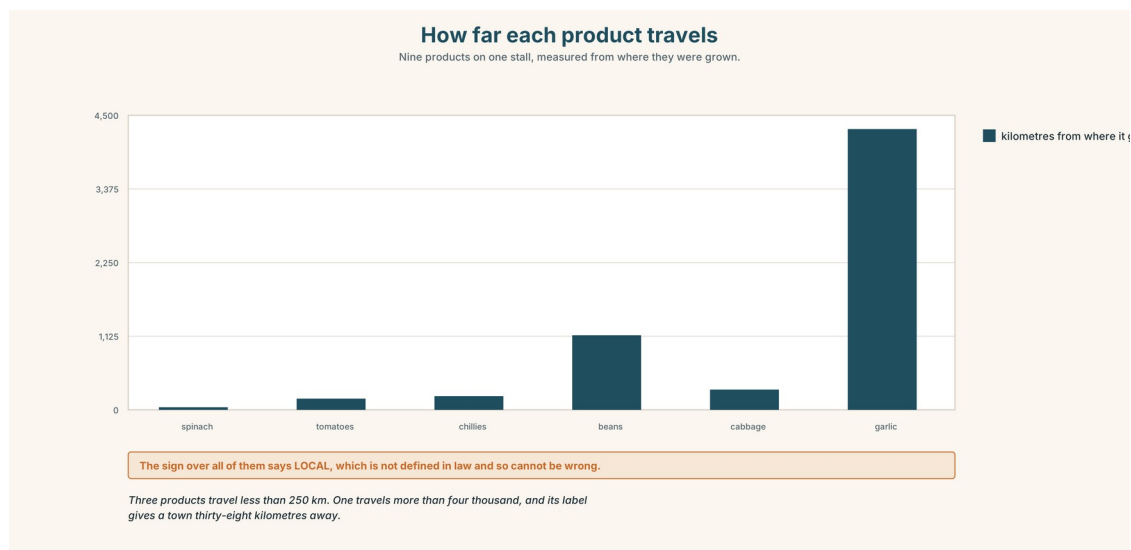
Which one is an accusation?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **three things in this room, and where each was made.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

Where it comes from • 90 words



6in}

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How far each product travels — Nine products on one stall, measured from where they were grown.

8A • Read the model

The coffee is grown in Aceh, about 1,400 km from here, on farms of two or three hectares.
[a number, and it is the distance — which is the fact the label leaves out]

It is picked by hand, dried on concrete beside the road, and sold to a buyer who comes up the valley twice a month. Then it is sent to Medan and roasted there. [four passives, no agents, because none of them would help]

I do not know who the buyer is. Nobody I asked knew his name, and he has been coming for eleven years. [the honest gap, and it is specific]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. Four passives in one paragraph and no agent in any of them. **Is that evasive here?**
2. The last paragraph admits ignorance. **What does that do to the first two?**

8B • The anti-model

This product comes from a beautiful region with a long tradition. It is produced using traditional methods by local farmers who care about quality. It is then exported all over the world.

Correct English, and it could be about anything. **Name three facts it is missing.**

8C • Plan

where it starts, with a distance → what is done to it, in order → where it is sold → one thing you could not find out

8D • Write — 90 words

8E • Peer review — two criteria

☐ Is there a distance or a date? ☐ Is there one honest gap?

8F • Write it again • 8G • Publish

On the wall, with the three labels from Part 5E beside it.

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

WORK FILE • The Remote Problem

Four moves on a bad line
Nobody can see anybody. Everything that is usually a look has to be said.

1	2	3	4
who, and where	a date is harder to argue with	a name beats a department	one step, one date
			
"This is Hafiz at Chow Kit, stall 14."	"Twice - the fourth and the eleventh."	"Who should I ask for next time?"	"So you'll call me back by Thursday."
hello			Thursday

6in}

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Four moves on a bad line — Nobody can see anybody. Everything that is usually a look has to be said.

9A • A problem nobody is in the room for Track 7.4

The Selangor packer has sent the wrong garlic twice. Nobody at the market has met anybody there. **Listen to the call.**

1. How many people are on the call, and who has the authority to fix it?
2. What has been agreed by the end?
3. **One person says something that stops the call going round in circles. What?**

9B • The four moves on a bad line

saying who you are • stating the problem with a date • asking for one named person • agreeing what happens by when

Match each to one phrase.

"This is Hafiz at Chow Kit, stall 14." • "Twice — the fourth and the eleventh." • "Who should I ask for next time?" • "So you'll call me back by Thursday."

9C • When you cannot see each other

Being unable to see somebody changes what you have to say out loud. **Which three of these do you have to say on a call that you would not say face to face?**

"I'm still here." • "Sorry, go ahead." • "Can I just check I've understood?" • "Yes." • "I'm writing this down."

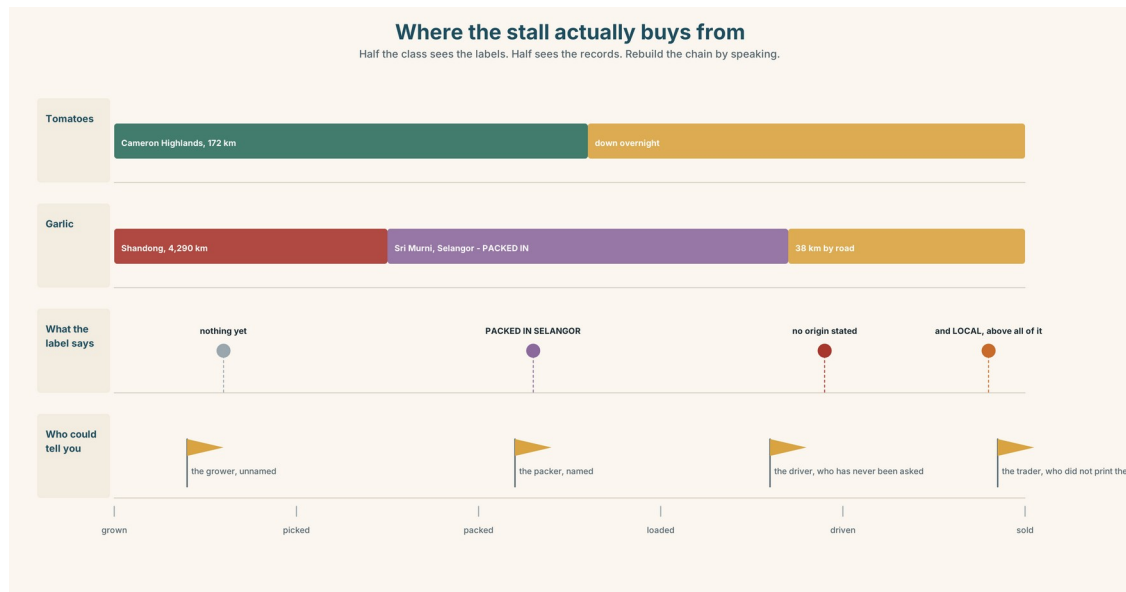
9D • Your turn

In pairs, back to back. **Six minutes.** One of you has a problem with an order. The other works for the supplier and does not have the authority to fix it. **You must both leave with one named next step.**

9E • Transfer

Make one real call or message this week where you ask for a named person and a date. Bring what you got.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



6in}

Where the stall actually buys from — Half the class sees the labels. Half sees the records. Rebuild the chain by speaking.

10A • Relay

Half the class sees the labels. Half sees the delivery records. **Rebuild the whole supply chain by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify

Explain the three labels from Part 5E to a shopper who wants to buy only Malaysian produce. **Four sentences only.**

Plan: which one is → which one is not → which one you cannot tell → what to ask the trader

10C • Compress

The feature in Part 5 into **thirty-five words**, as a card to pin beside the sign.

10D • Online

Write **one message** to the packer: two deliveries were wrong, you want a named contact, and you want a reply by Thursday.

10E • Your language

How does your language make a passive? **Does it have one at all, or does it use *people say* or *one does*?** Show a partner the label *grown in China* in both languages.

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

The sign, or the sourcing

The sign above the stall says LOCAL. Half the produce under it travels four hundred kilometres, and the garlic comes from China by way of a packer in Selangor. Nothing illegal is happening.

- **Change the sign.** Take the word down. Lose whatever it was bringing in.
- **Change the sourcing.** Buy only Malaysian. Prices go up between nine and fourteen per cent and three products disappear for four months of the year.
- **Change what the sign says.** Keep it, and add the distances underneath, in small print.

11A • The evidence

1. **The three labels and the delivery record** from Part 5E.
2. **The chart** — where each product is grown, and how far it travels.
3. **The voice.** Siti, twenty seconds: *"I have never said the word local to a customer in thirty-one years. Somebody printed it and I let them hang it, which I suppose is the same thing."*

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Everybody says one. Use the frame.

I think they should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: *honest • grown • imported • price • belong • roots • foreign • trust*

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think they should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

They should put the distances up. The feature is right that the sign is a claim about who you hand your money to, and that claim is true — but it is being made with a word that sounds like geography, and the fix is not to argue about the word. It is to put the four hundred kilometres next to it and let the customer decide what *local* meant all along.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. They printed the distances on small cards and put one in front of each crate. It took an afternoon.

For three weeks almost nobody read them. Then a food writer photographed the cards and the photograph was shared about nine thousand times, mostly by people who had never been to the market, and for a month the stall was busier than it had ever been.

Two other traders copied the cards. Four were angry about it, because customers had started asking them for distances they did not know.

It worked, and then it worked too well, and it made four people's lives harder.

Was it the right decision? Say why — and say what you would say to the four.

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — ten items

1. The rice _____ (grow) in Kedah.
2. This house _____ (build) in 1961.
3. It's made _____ Vietnam.
4. She was _____ in Penang.
5. I grew _____ two streets from here.
6. (Unit 6) I can't afford _____ (buy) it.
7. (Unit 6) Do you mind _____ (wait) ?
8. (Unit 5) If it _____ (rain), we'll stay.
9. (Unit 3) I _____ (use) to live here.
10. (Starting Out) Where _____ you from?

12B • Consolidate

Ninety words, one paragraph. One thing in your home and where it came from. At least four passives, one *by* phrase, and one thing you do not know.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

I can...	My evidence	Sure?
say what is done to something without naming who	Part 3G score	☐ ☒ ☒
trace one thing back in eighty seconds	Part 4C recording	☐ ☒ ☒
write ninety words with a distance and a gap	Part 8 draft 2	☐ ☒ ☒
get a named contact and a date on a call	Part 9D role play	☐ ☒ ☒

12D • Replay 🟡

Find your thirty seconds from Part 0C. Listen. **Record it again.** One sentence: what is different?

12E • Glossary — forty items, as a map

WHERE YOU STARTED • born • be born in • raise • be brought up • grow up • family • roots
THE PLACE • home • village • town • country • move • move away • go back • settle • settle in
THE PAPERS • passport • visa • citizen • foreign • language • accent • belong • it's complicated
MADE • made • be made in • built • be built by • by hand • by machine • at the factory **GROWN** • grown • be grown in **MOVED** • sold • be sold at • sent • brought • taken • given • nobody knows who

12F • Next

Unit 8 • What are you allowed to do?